

A Quick Look at Open Source Centralised Storage Solutions



Centralised network storage technologies improve the utilisation of disks and facilitate fast access of data. NAS and SAN storage solutions offer file-level and block-level access to data, respectively. This article discusses NAS and SAN in detail and mentions a few open source storage solutions.

Centralised storage options, unlike the directly attached storage (DAS) ones that are locally attached to a machine, allow all servers to access the same pool of storage space. NAS (network attached storage) and SAN (storage area network) are the most common among these. Storage systems are very much like servers, consisting of a motherboard, CPU, memory, DRAM, disk subsystems and NIC cards. All these components are in the same unit called a controller or a head. A proprietary operating system from the vendor, which is installed in the controller, controls communications to the client over the network and runs all the features on the storage system, like deduplication and compression.

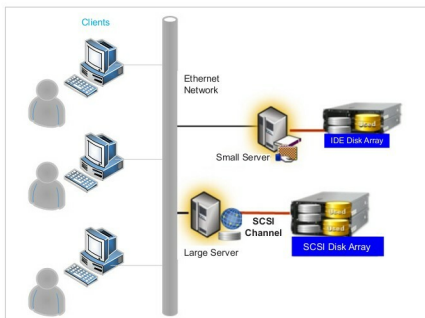


Figure 1: Direct access storage